	7.2. ENVIRONMENTAL CONTROL	
	Document no: ASMF7.2.3.	
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

ENVIRONMENTAL CONTROL

1. Purpose

To ensure that the environmental conditions within the laboratory facility are **monitored, controlled, and maintained** to prevent contamination, degradation, or variation in reference material properties.

2. Scope

Applies to all production, testing, packaging, and storage areas where reference materials (RMs or CRMs) are handled.

3. References

- ISO 17034:2016, Clauses 6.4, 7.4, 7.5, 7.6, 7.7, 7.8
- ISO/IEC 17025:2017, Clauses 6.3 and 6.4
- Internal SOPs on Material Handling, Stability Studies, and Quality Control

4. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Laboratory Manager	Implement SOPs for Environmental conditions
Laboratory Supervisor	Ensure compliance with environmental requirements
Laboratory Analyst	Perform routine checks, record conditions
Maintenance Personnel	Maintain heating, Ventilation and Air-conditioning (HVAC).

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5. Control Environmental Parameters

Parameter	Acceptable Range	Controlled Areas
Temperature	19-26 °C	All preparation, weighing, and packaging
Humidity	25-45 % RH (unless specified)	Drying, crushing, packaging, analysis.
Particulate	Minimal visible particles	Cleanroom or clean bench
Airflow	Positive pressure if required	Clean areas
Light	Avoid direct sunlight	Storage and packaging

6. Environmental Control Procedure

6.1. Daily Monitoring

- Check and record temperature and humidity before starting with work and closely monitor these throughout the shift.
- Use calibrated hygrometers and thermometers

6.2. Cleaning and Sanitation

- Clean benches, scales, and packaging areas daily using approved disinfectants.
- Floors and walls cleaned as needed.

6.3. Pest and Contamination Control

- Materials must be kept in closed, labelled containers.
- Food and drinks strictly prohibited in lab and storage areas.

7. Control of Non-conforming Conditions

- Inform supervisor and stop critical activities
- Label the affected area/equipment as “Do not use”.
- Conduct the impact assessment for affected area.
- Complete a nonconformance report and initiate corrective action.

8. Record Keeping

Record Name	Retention period (in years)	Stored by
Daily environmental log	5	Laboratory Manager
Data Logger reports	5	IT/LIMS
Non-conformance report	10	Operations Manager

9. Training

All staff working in controlled areas must be trained on:

- Good environmental hygiene
- SOP for environmental monitoring

Training must be documented and environmental conditions included in SOPs.

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10. Review and updates

SOP to be reviewed annually or when:

- A new environmental control system is implemented
- If there is a deviation that impacts the quality of product
- Regulatory or ISO requirements become updated.

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